

Words, Tone & Style - Practice Workbook

Mixed skill practice before moving to full passage sets.

Use this after the individual guides

Each section mixes the five word-and-style skills. Identify which skill the question is really asking before you answer.

Library Notice

The library will pilot a quiet-hour policy for four weeks. Staff describe the change as a test rather than a permanent rule.

1. What does pilot mean here?

- A. test on a limited basis
- B. operate an airplane
- C. lead a tour
- D. cancel permanently

2. What tone does test rather than permanent rule help create?

- A. cautious
- B. furious
- C. celebratory
- D. sarcastic

River Path

The new path hugs the riverbank, bending with the water instead of cutting a straight line through the trees.

3. What does hugs mean?

- A. follows closely
- B. touches with arms
- C. blocks
- D. repairs

4. Why is hugs more effective than follows?

- A. It creates a more vivid image of closeness.
- B. It proves the path is shorter.
- C. It makes the river wider.
- D. It makes the sentence neutral.

Committee Comment

One member called the proposal bold; another called it reckless.

5. What does the contrast show?

- A. different attitudes toward a similar willingness to take risk
- B. different proposal dates
- C. different facts about cost
- D. no difference in attitude

6. Which is more approving?

- A. bold
- B. reckless
- C. proposal
- D. member

Answer key and reasoning

1. A. The phrase for four weeks and test rather than permanent rule define the contextual meaning.
2. A. The wording emphasizes temporary evaluation rather than certainty.
3. A. The path bends with the river and stays close to it.
4. A. The figurative verb creates a stronger image.
5. A. The words overlap in risk-taking but have positive and negative connotations.
6. A. Bold often admires courage; reckless criticizes unsafe risk.

Next step

If one skill repeatedly causes trouble, return to that skill page and use its Study Guide, Workbook sheets, and Interactive Practice before returning to mixed passage work.